

Definition. Suppose all the Riemann sums for a function $f(x)$ on an interval $[a, b]$ get arbitrarily close to a single number when the lengths $\Delta x_1, \dots, \Delta x_n$ are made small enough. Then this number is called the **integral** of $f(x)$ on $[a, b]$ and it is denoted

$$\int_a^b f(x) \, dx.$$